Nicholas Rode

Product & Interactive Motion Designer

Contact

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281.794.1242
Vancouver, WA
Portfolio · Motion Reel

Skills

Motion & interaction
Rive (state machines, interactive components), After Effects, Lottie/Bodymovin, UI animation, 2D/3D animation, compositing

Design
Figma (including motion), Illustrator, UI/UX design, design systems, interactive prototyping

Production & performance
Rive web runtimes (React, Canvas, WebGL2), Lottie JSON delivery, WebGL shaders, Lighthouse performance tuning, reduced-motion accessibility, developer handoff

AI & building
Claude Code, AI-assisted tool building, Figma plugin development

Education

Art Institute of Seattle
Nucamp, Full Stack Web Design 2020

Product and interactive motion designer for AI and SaaS companies, including Gong, Fireworks AI, and Deepgram. I use whatever gets motion shipped (Rive, Lottie, After Effects, Figma, or code) and build AI tools that close the gap between design and production.

Experience

Motion Designer, Webstacks
Jan 2025 – Present

B2B web design and development agency

- Shipped interactive motion, animation, and illustration for Gong and Fireworks AI, including product UI motion for Fireworks AI
- Built 4 interactive Rive product demos for Deepgram's AI voice platform: voice-to-text, voice avatars, assistant states, and a Slack integration walkthrough
- Designed a 10-piece Rive animation system for Shep's rebrand, turning automation, security, and scale into one visual language
- Choose and optimize animation runtimes for mobile web performance
- Ship production Rive state machines with reduced-motion support and cross-device playback

Junior Designer (Product UI & Motion), Variable Medium
Jan 2021 – Dec 2024

- Designed the desktop and mobile peer-to-peer trading app for Evaluate, from interactive prototypes for user testing through launch, plus its marketing site and onboarding video
- Designed trade and chat flows, including asynchronous offers with expiry dates so traders don't need to be online at the same time
- Built advanced interactive prototypes for user testing and developer handoff
- Contributed to design system development and created motion that clarified complex product flows

Freelance Motion Designer & Illustrator, Self-employed
Jul 2024 – Present

- Deliver motion graphics, illustration, and web and mobile design for tech, SaaS, and B2B clients

Tools I've Built

Sequence to Shader: An AI-built pipeline that converts After Effects renders into lightweight WebGL shaders with measured accuracy, delivered as a drop-in module for developers.

Figma → React: A Figma plugin that generates reliable React code from designs, reducing design-to-code drift.

Courses

Rive Masterclass
TheMotionMagic, Ultimate Rive Animation Course
School of Motion, A Motion Design Masterpiece